BY ORDER OF THE SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

SPACE FORCE INSTRUCTION 13-603

15 SEPTEMBER 2026

Nuclear, Space, Missile, Command and Control

FORCE DESIGN AND DEVELOPMENT

COMPLIANCE WITH THIS PUBLICATION IS MANDATORY

ACCESSIBILITY: This publication is available for downloading or ordering on the e-Publishing website at www.e-Publishing.af.mil

RELEASABILITY: There are no releasability restrictions on this publication

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OPR: SF/S5F

Certified by: VCSO (Gen Shawn N. Bratton)

Supersedes: SPFI13-602, 10 September 2026

Pages: 36

This publication implements Department of the Air Force Policy Directive 13-6, Space Policy. It provides guidance and procedures on organizational roles, responsibilities, authorities, and processes for the management of United States Space Force (USSF) Force Design and Force Development processes. This publication applies to uniformed members of the USSF, Department of the Air Force (DAF) civilian employees and those with a contractual obligation to abide by the terms of DAF publications except where otherwise noted. This publication does not apply to the United States Air Force, except units performing space missions. Ensure all records generated as a result of processes prescribed in this publication adhere to Air Force Instruction 33-322, Records Management and Information Governance Program, and are disposed in accordance with the Air Force Records Disposition Schedule, which is located in the Air Force Records Information Management System. For recommended changes and questions about this publication, contact the office of primary responsibility (OPR) using DAF Form 847, Recommendation for Change of Publication. Route DAF Form 847 from the field through the appropriate functional chain of command. This publication may be supplemented at any level, but all direct supplements must be routed to the OPR of this publication for coordination prior to certification and approval. The authorities to waive installation/unit level requirements in this publication are identified with a Tier ("T-0, T-1, T-2, and T-3") number following the compliance statement. Submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to the appropriate tier waiver approval authority, or alternately, to the publication OPR for non–tiered compliance items. See DAF Manual (DAFMAN) 90–161, Publishing Processes and Procedures, for a description of the authorities associated with the Tier numbers.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This instruction incorporates significant changes to paragraphs and references previously featured in SPFGM 2025-90-01, *Force Design & Force Development Process*. Additionally, this instruction includes higher level Force Design language to enable the Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Force Design and Analysis (SF/S9) to draft implementation guidance.

Chapter 1—INTRODUCTION **4**

1.1. Purpose. 4

1.2. Description. 4

1.3. Scope. 5

Chapter 2—FORCE DESIGN **7**

2.1. Purpose. 7

2.2. Process Sequencing and Decision Points. 7

Figure 2.1. Process Sequencing and Decision Points. 7

2.3. Objective Force. 9

Chapter 3—FORCE DESIGN GOVERNANCE **13**

3.1. Purpose. 13

3.2. Mission Area Design Teams. 13

3.3. Force Design Council. 13

Chapter 4—FORCE DESIGN ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES **15**

4.1. Chief of Space Operations (CSO) in the capacity of the Force Design Architect for Space Systems of the Armed Forces. 15

4.2. Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Space Acquisition and Integration (SAF/SQ). 15

4.3. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Human Capital (SF/S1). 16

4.4. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Intelligence (SF/S2). 16

4.5. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Operations (SF/S3/4/7). 16

4.6. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Strategy, Plans, Programs and Requirements (SF/S5/8). 16

4.7. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Cyber and Data (SF/S6). 17

4.8. Space Force Test and Evaluation Directorate (SF/TE). 17

4.9. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Force Design & Analysis (SF/S9). 17

4.10. Combat Forces Command (CFC). 18

4.11. Space Training and Readiness Command (STARCOM). 18

4.12. Other Services, Interagency, and CCMD LNOs. 19
4.13. Portfolio Acquisition Executive (PAE) & other Acquisition Organizations. 19
4.14. Science & Technology Enterprise Organization Leadership. 19

Chapter 5—FORCE DEVELOPMENT **20**

5.1. Purpose. 20
5.2. Description. 20
5.3. Force Development Process. 20
Figure 5.1. Force Development LOEs. 21
5.4. Strategy & Integration (LOE 1). 21
5.5. Future Technology & Innovation (LOE 2). 22
5.6. Capability Development (LOE 3). 23
5.7. Resource Allocation (LOE 4). 24
5.8. Resource Allocation and Programmatic Synchronization. 25

Chapter 6—FORCE DEVELOPMENT ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES **26**

6.1. Chief of Space Operations (CSO) in the capacity of the Force Design Architect for Space Systems of the Armed Forces. 26
6.2. Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Space Acquisition and Integration (SAF/SQ). 26
6.3. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Human Capital (SF/S1). 27
6.4. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Intelligence (SF/S2). 27
6.5. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Operations (SF/S3/4/7). 27
6.6. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Strategy, Plans, Programs and Requirements (SF/S5/8). 28
6.7. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Cyber and Data (SF/S6). 28
6.8. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Force Design & Analysis (SF/S9). 28
6.9. Space Force Test and Evaluation Directorate (SF/TE). 29
6.10. Combat Forces Command (CFC). 29
6.11. Space Training and Readiness Command (STARCOM). 30
6.12. Space System Command (SSC). 30
6.13. Portfolio Acquisition Executive (PAE) and other Acquisition Organizations. 30
6.14. Science & Technology Enterprise Organizations. 31
6.15. Other Services, Interagency, and CCMD LNOs. 31

Attachment 1—GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION **32**

Chapter 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1. Purpose. This instruction establishes Service guidance and procedures for the Headquarters (HQ) Space Staff, Field Commands (FLDCOM), and Direct Reporting Units (DRU) on how to manage and execute the USSF's Force Design and Force Development processes. It further supports the Chief of Space Operations (CSO) in the statutory role as Force Design Architect for Space Systems of the Armed Forces. This publication emphasizes integration with joint, allied, partner, commercial, and civil entities to ensure a comprehensive Objective Force that leverages and integrates available capabilities manifesting into the Programmed Force. This instruction is intended to guide collaboration by establishing organizational roles, responsibilities, authorities, and general governance activities for the management and execution of Force Design and Force Development processes.

1.2. Description. This instruction establishes the official framework for the first two phases of the USSF's Force Modernization Continuum: Force Design and Force Development. The full continuum progresses through four stages, ultimately including Force Generation and Force Employment. It defines the formal processes and responsibilities required to translate the USSF's long-term strategic vision into fielded, combat-credible space capabilities as part of a coherent, integrated architecture, intentionally designed to achieve space superiority and an optimally burdened Programmed Force. This document details the reciprocal relationship between Force Design, which conceptualizes the future "Objective Force," and Force Development, which builds the "Programmed Force" through integrated planning, capability development, and resource allocation. The guidance herein ensures a synchronized, enterprise-wide approach for how the USSF can outpace adversary threats and deliver effects for the joint force.

1.2.1. Force Design. Force Design is the Service-level activity by which the USSF determines the future force it needs to deliver joint warfighter effects. It is one of the four phases of the continuum that make up the ecosystem that envisions and ultimately fields future space forces. Focused on the five-to-fifteen-year time horizon, Force Design is a continual and reciprocal process that conceptualizes, analyzes, assesses, and recommends what capabilities, capacity, and force structure are required for the USSF to accomplish its missions and defeat a thinking adversary over the next three Future Years Defense Programs (FYDPs). It must consider strategy, policy, Combatant Command (CCMD) plans, warfighting needs, threat projections, and budget cycles to guide USSF capability development in support of the future joint force. It continuously informs and is informed by Force Development, Force Generation, and Force Employment.

1.2.2. Objective Force. A primary output of the Force Design process is the Objective Force, a guidepost for force structure and posture, capabilities, and systems the USSF requires to achieve space superiority and deliver effects to the joint force in the Future Operating Environment (FOE). It influences force structure decision-making by serving as the principal USSF strategic guidance document driving all Force Development activities, including mission and enterprise requirements, resource allocation decisions, and capability prioritizations. Across the Service, the Objective Force establishes recommendations for capabilities the Service "shall" pursue. All USSF organizations will align their Planning, Programming, Budgeting, and Execution (PPBE) activities with the approved Objective Force

to ensure unity of effort toward common strategic objectives. The Objective Force is published every five years following a comprehensive review of all mission areas, with annual updates as warranted by strategic guidance changes or approved Mission Area Design (MAD) recommendations. It illustrates force delivery checkpoints with finer near-term clarity that enable planners, programmers, and acquirers to envision, invest in, and develop capabilities while remaining flexible as conditions change.

1.2.3. Force Development. Force Development is a dynamic and integrated framework designed to translate the long-term strategic vision for space capabilities into tangible, fielded realities for the warfighter. It functions as a continuous, cyclical engine rather than a linear, step-by-step procedure and serves as the second phase of the Force Modernization Continuum. Across a 2–7-year time horizon, Force Development is where the USSF works to achieve the Objective Force through requirements generation, planning, resourcing, procurement, demonstration, and testing of future capabilities and associated force structure (people, tactics, training, facilities, etc.) while adapting to unexpected challenges, as needed.

1.2.4. Programmed Force. The Programmed Force, a primary output of the Force Development process, consists of the capabilities, facilities, infrastructure, personnel, science and technology investment, etc., that have been allocated funding through the PPBE process over the course of the first FYDP. The Programmed Force is not static and changes from one Program Objective Memorandum (POM) cycle to the next. Differences between the Objective Force and the Programmed Force indicate areas of capability gaps.

1.3. Scope. This instruction expands upon the framework established in CJCSI 3030.01B, *Implementing Joint Force Development and Design*. It outlines the interconnected processes of Force Design and Force Development. Together, these processes provide a coherent mechanism to envision, develop, and field a future joint force capable of meeting projected warfighting needs and space superiority.

1.3.1. Force Design. This function determines the recommended future force through analytic activities such as service-level warfighting concept development, studies, wargaming, experimentation, and modeling and simulation. The process synthesizes strategic guidance (e.g., National Security Strategy, National Defense Strategy), projections of the FOE, joint needs, and allied, partner, and commercial capabilities - all within realistic budget constraints. It culminates in the Objective Force, the primary source for all subsequent Force Modernization activities.

1.3.2. Force Development. This function provides the mechanism to develop new capabilities and/or modify existing systems to meet warfighting needs. As described in CJCSI 3030.01B, all Force Development activities are scoped and informed by the Objective Force. This ensures that development efforts are directly aligned with the validated future warfighting needs identified during the Force Design process.

1.3.2.1. In-Scope Activities. Force Development governs the integration and execution of four primary lines of effort (LOE) outlined below.

1.3.2.1.1. Strategy & Integration. The creation, maintenance, and adaptation of the Mission Area Development Plan (MADP), which synchronizes all development activities.

1.3.2.1.2. Capability Development. The execution of the MADP, encompassing the capability development process, formal requirements process, materiel acquisition, and the implementation of all supporting DOTmLPF-P (Doctrine, Organization, Training, materiel, Leadership and Education, Personnel, Facilities and Policy) elements.

1.3.2.1.3. Resource Allocation. The formal PPBE process to fund and staff development efforts, resulting in the “Programmed Force.”

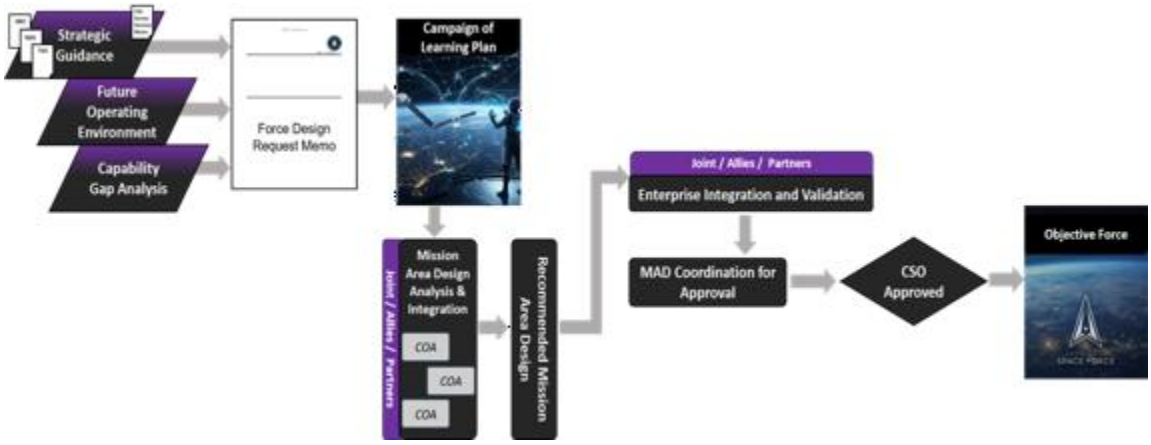
Chapter 2

FORCE DESIGN

2.1. Purpose. This Chapter describes the Force Design process for developing recommendations on the capabilities and force structure the Space Force should develop, procure, or divest. The process considers mission area interdependencies, enterprise integration, enforceable standards, and interoperability to inform Service decisions on space system investments and divestments that balance current and future needs. A Force Design is the blueprint that expresses the size of the force in manpower and equipment; the structure of the force; the concepts and capabilities the force uses to conduct its missions; and the training, posture, and other activities required to achieve national objectives.

2.2. Process Sequencing and Decision Points.

Figure 2.1. Process Sequencing and Decision Points.



2.2.1. Force Design Process. The Force Design process considers mission area interdependencies, enterprise integration, enforceable standards, and interoperability to inform Service decisions on space system requirements and investments that balance current and future needs. Through an iterative, multi-phased process, Force Design produces Mission Area Designs (MADs) and other recommendations that inform updates to the Objective Force.

2.2.2. Process Sequencing. The process begins with a review of strategic guidance, the FOE, capability gap analyses, and other inputs. Force Design requests are solicited through an annual Force Design Request Memo. These inputs inform the five-year Force Design Campaign of Learning (CoL) Plan, which guides Force Design activities and generates learning through concept development, experimentation, wargaming, and analysis. Additionally, the CoL may also be informed by the issuance of a Decision Memorandum by the CSO. CSO's Decision Memo is strategic enterprise guidance to the force. During Force Design, it serves as the CSO's primary mechanism to communicate priorities, direct efforts, and scope Force Design Analysis and other Force Design related activities.

2.2.2.1. Force Design Request Memo. Each five-year Force Design epoch begins with a continuous set of inputs including National, Department of War (DoW), Joint, and Service-level strategic guidance; the FOE; joint and Combatant Command needs, approved Concept Required Capabilities (CRCs), international partnership opportunities, emerging technologies and commercial capabilities; and other Service direction (e.g. new or divested missions). SF/S9 issues an annual Force Design Request Memo to solicit and capture Force Design inputs and analysis requests from HQ USSF, FLDCOMs, SAF, and other required stakeholders. To maintain flexibility, stakeholders may submit out-of-cycle Force Design and analysis requests to address emergent threats, rapid technological breakthroughs, or urgent operational mandates. These inputs and requests inform updates to the five-year Force Design CoL Plan.

2.2.2.2. Force Design Campaign of Learning (CoL) Plan. SF/S9 develops and staffs the five-year Force Design CoL Plan in coordination with USSF and other stakeholders. The CoL Plan establishes the scope, focus, priorities, and sequencing for Force Design activities and serves as the Service's central plan for executing Force Design. The plan is updated annually, or as needed, based on Force Design inputs and requests. CSO validates the CoL Plan. Once validated, SF/S9 issues and executes the CoL Plan.

2.2.2.3. Mission Design Analysis. As part of the CoL, SF/S9 conducts mission design analysis alongside modeling, simulation, wargaming, experimentation, and trade space exploration to produce MADs, which serve as the primary input to the Objective Force, which informs Force Development decisions. This comprehensive analysis evaluates joint needs, threats, technological opportunities, and commercial, allied, and partner capabilities to develop and assess Courses of Action (COAs) addressing performance, resilience, affordability, and DOTmLPF-P executability in the Future Operating Environment (FOE). The process proceeds through multiple USSF HQ decision points, yielding COAs that define alternative design approaches, system attributes, and cost implications, culminating in COA down-selection and DOTmLPF-P evaluation before generating the MAD.

2.2.2.4. Mission Area Design. MADs document Force Design recommendations for specific mission and enterprise areas to meet warfighter needs in the FOE. Mission design analysis and COA selection may occur at the full mission area level, such as Space Domain Awareness, or within a mission set, such as Space Surveillance. However, final DOTmLPF-P analysis and recommendations should be coordinated and approved at the mission area level to ensure mission set decisions are assessed within the broader mission context. MAD outputs inform Force Development by documenting performance metrics that inform requirements; Government Reference Architectures (GRAs) and cost profiles that inform resource planning and POM development; and DOTmLPF-P transition recommendations that inform MADP implementation plans.

2.2.2.4.1. Mission Design Integration. SF/S9 establishes cross-functional MAD Teams in partnership with Mission Area Working Groups (MAWGs) for substantial mission design efforts requiring integration across USSF and external stakeholders. MAD Teams include appropriate representation from, but not limited to, SF/S9 and FOAs; USSF HQ L2s,; FLDCOMs; SAF, PAEs, AFRL; Services; Joint Staff and DoW offices; and other required government stakeholders. MAD Teams coordinate recommendations with relevant stakeholders, as appropriate, to capture operational, acquisition, intelligence, policy, resource, joint, allied, partner, commercial, and civil considerations before key decision points.

2.2.2.4.2. Decision Points and USSF HQ Coordination. Mission design analysis includes several USSF HQ decision points used to make internal Service decisions, assess DOTmLPF-P implications, capture relevant USSF and external stakeholder views, and ensure recommendations are coordinated before advancing. The decision points include endorsement of the analytic plan and team composition; performance-versus-affordability down-selection; COA selection with supporting performance metrics, cost profiles, and a DOTmLPF-P plan; and MAD approval. Decision points are reviewed and coordinated through established SF/S9-led governance fora at the O-6/civilian equivalent and GO/FO levels, as described in the Oversight and Management section of this instruction.

2.2.2.4.3. Enterprise Integration and Validation. SF/S9 conducts enterprise integration and validation to assess mission area recommendations against the broader Objective Force architecture. This assessment identifies gaps, seams, priorities, dependencies, and cross-mission implications. Enterprise integration and validation may occur during mission design analysis and continue after USSF HQ MAD coordination to enable timely decisions and approval while preserving follow-on integration work.

2.2.2.4.4. Final Coordination and Approval. SF/S9 provides final MAD recommendations to the VCSO for endorsement prior to General Officer/Flag Officer (GO/FO) joint, and DoW coordination if applicable. Feedback from these reviews is returned for additional mission design analysis, as required, or presented with the MAD to the VCSO or CSO for final approval and integration into the Objective Force.

2.3. Objective Force. The Objective Force outlines the USSF's required future posture, capabilities, and systems. These elements are essential for achieving space superiority and providing space-based effects to support the joint force in the FOE. As the primary output of the Force Design process and the central guiding document for service capabilities development activities, the Objective Force drives Force Development activities to include mission and enterprise requirements, resource allocation decisions, and capability prioritization across the Service while providing the strategic foundation for outpacing adversary capabilities.

2.3.1. Definition and Characteristics. As outlined in *Space Force Vector 2025*, the Objective Force represents the necessary capabilities, capacity, and force structure required for Guardians to accomplish their missions and defeat a thinking adversary over the next three FYDPs. The Objective Force describes the force the Service believes it will need to fight and win future battles based on a forecast of threats expected in the FOE, strategy, future operating concepts, future and current requirements, technologies, and the geopolitical environment.

2.3.2. Key Tenets.

2.3.2.1. The Force Design process and analysis of the future needs of the Space Force are continually evolving and iterative as information about technology, needs, and threats change.

2.3.2.2. It is not concrete but represents the best-informed estimation at that time, producing a range of options to account for uncertainty.

2.3.2.3. It focuses on a specific 15-year epoch (e.g., 2030-2045) that is continually iterated as input variables change.

2.3.2.4. It illustrates force delivery checkpoints with finer near-term clarity that enables planners and programmers to envision, invest in, and develop capabilities while remaining flexible to changes as learning occurs.

2.3.2.5. It captures capability needs that are cohesive across core and enterprise functions, all driven by common mission priorities.

2.3.3. Resource-Informed Product. The Objective Force is a DOTmLPF-P resource-informed product that conceptually identifies the units, formations, and equipment required to ensure space superiority and delivery of effects to the joint fight. It estimates the DOTmLPF-P resource requirements, providing a comprehensive estimation of the future force structure supporting elements.

2.3.4. Primary Source Document. The Objective Force document is the U.S. Space Force's primary source guide for future force development. It directs service-wide investment priorities spanning Research and Development, the fielding of new operational capabilities, and the sustainment of the current force. All USSF organizations shall use this document to align their PPBE activities, ensuring a unified enterprise-wide effort toward achieving strategic objectives.

2.3.5. Composition. The Objective Force is comprised of multiple integrated MADs that have undergone enterprise planning and validation, a horizontal analysis across the enterprise, to ensure horizontal integration across all mission areas. Each MAD establishes what a particular mission area needs to be successful in the anticipated FOE.

2.3.6. Approval Authority and Governance. Not every Force Design recommendation automatically becomes part of the Objective Force. Just as every future operating concept is not implemented, not every aspect of a MAD will be endorsed for inclusion into the Objective Force.

2.3.6.1. CSO Approval. The CSO approves the Objective Force and any additions, removals, and modifications, exercising authority as part of the CSO's statutory role as Force Design Architect for Space Systems of the Armed Forces.

2.3.7. Space Risk Assessment (SRA). The CSO monitors and reports annually to the Secretary of the Air Force on the operational risk across all mission areas, informed by capability gaps, force design analysis, and Joint inputs, fulfilling statutory requirements for Force Design architect responsibilities.

2.3.7.1. Annual Reporting. This SRA report is provided to the Secretary of the Air Force and informs the Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff Risk Assessment, which ultimately informs the Chairman of the Joint Chiefs, Secretary of War, and Congress of the status of the joint space architecture.

2.3.8. Relationship to Other Force Constructs. The Objective Force maintains active connections to the Strategic Context, Resource Planning, Programmed Force, and Force Development constructs detailed below.

2.3.8.1. Strategic Context. The Objective Force helps determine what capabilities and force structure the joint force should develop and procure by incorporating and testing concepts and technologies through experimentation, analysis, and wargames. It provides the strategic foundation for outpacing adversary capabilities while building credibility with Congress and affording partners and allies an avenue to shape, engage, and bring capability to the fight.

2.3.8.2. Resource Planning. The resource planning process translates the path to achieving the Objective Force in terms of cost, and optimally phases and prioritizes funding beyond the first FYDP. The data is captured in the Resource Allocation Plan (RAP) and directly informs future POM development.

2.3.8.3. Programmed Force. The Programmed Force consists of capabilities, facilities, infrastructure, personnel, and S&T investments that have been allocated funding through the PPBE process over the course of the current FYDP. Differences between the Objective Force and the Programmed Force indicate areas of strategic regret that must be balanced against current operational requirements.

2.3.8.4. Force Development. The Objective Force serves as the primary driver for all Force Development efforts and the source of strategic direction and capability priorities, ensuring unity of effort across the Service. All four LOEs refer to the Objective Force as the source of strategic direction and capability priorities, ensuring unity of effort across the Service.

2.3.8.4.1. Force Structure Assessment. Before any funding requirements are finalized, HQ USSF S5/8 conducts a holistic Force Structure Assessment (FSA). This assessment reviews the entire mission area as a whole by analyzing the projected lifecycle costs and identifying all supporting and enabling infrastructure requirements for the approved capability solutions. The purpose of this assessment is to ensure that all the planned capabilities within the mission area have the required supporting and enabling infrastructure properly identified and budgeted.

2.3.8.4.2. Mission Area Development Plan (MADP). MADPs track, monitor, and report on the Objective Force's progress, serving as the primary implementation mechanism for translating the Objective Force vision into actionable development activities. MADPs capture the latest status for specific mission areas and high-level roadmaps for each capability within the mission area, defining timelines for transitioning to new architectures.

2.3.8.4.3. Requirements. The requirements process intakes data from the Objective Force to drive updates or creation of mission area and enterprise requirement documents, ensuring alignment between validated requirements and strategic Force Design decisions. This interface ensures that requirements development is driven by strategic Force Design rather than ad hoc capability needs.

2.3.8.4.4. Planning, Programming, Budgeting, & Execution Integration. During the PPBE process, the Objective Force is referenced as the primary source for resourcing priorities, ensuring that the budget is developed in alignment with the Objective Force. Leveraged during the PPBE process, the MADPs provide the critical pathway for resource alignment and modernization priorities, while the POM drives updates to the MADPs.

2.3.9. Assessment and Sustainment Planning. Upon publication, organizations across the USSF and the joint force will assess the Objective Force to ensure the various capabilities it identifies, as well as the associated force structure and sustainment requirements, are planned for and purpose-built within anticipated resource constraints.

2.3.9.1. Organizational Assessment. Upon publication, organizations across the USSF and the joint force will assess the Objective Force to ensure the various capabilities it identifies, as well as the associated force structure and sustainment requirements, are planned for and purpose-built within anticipated resource constraints.

2.3.9.2. Threat Assessment. During design and publication writing, the Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Intelligence (SF/S2) assesses the Objective Force to ensure that it addresses projected threats and incorporates intelligence projections of foreign governmental, civil, and commercial space capabilities to inform strategic planning. Any threat-driven Objective Force deficiencies are documented, identified and provided to SF/S9 for design consideration.

2.3.9.3. Sustainment Planning. Prior to publication, the Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Strategy, Plans, Programs, and Requirements (SF/S5/8) assess the Objective Force to ensure the various capabilities and associated force structure and sustainment requirements are planned, projected and incorporated in the RAP to ensure funding availability.

2.3.9.4. Enterprise Infrastructure Assessment. During design and publication writing, the Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Cyber and Data (SF/S6) validates the Objective Force to identify critical digital infrastructure and system dependencies and deficiencies.

2.3.10. Dissemination and Access. Access to and sharing of the Objective Force will be managed according to clear Service guidelines.

2.3.10.1. Wide Dissemination. The Objective Force will be widely disseminated and will be publicly available and published at the lowest level possible to ensure broad understanding and alignment across the Service.

2.3.10.2. Classification and Security. Access to the Objective Force will be managed according to appropriate security classifications, ensuring operational security while enabling necessary coordination and planning activities across the Service and with joint, allied, partner, commercial, and civil organizations.

2.3.10.3. Stakeholder Engagement. The Objective Force serves as the foundation for engagement with Congress, joint, allies, partners, and commercial entities. It provides credible long-term planning that enables targeted investments early while creating opportunities to change courses with minimal loss as conditions evolve.

Chapter 3

FORCE DESIGN GOVERNANCE

3.1. Purpose. This Chapter outlines governance for integrating stakeholder equities and coordinating recommendations across SF/S9-led Force Design activities. These governance forums promote early cross-organizational collaboration, capture stakeholder views, address unresolved issues, and support timely recommendations to senior leaders while preserving the distinct roles, responsibilities, and decision authorities for Force Design.

3.2. Mission Area Design Teams. SF/S9 establishes cross-functional Mission Area Design Teams as O-6/civilian equivalent forums for substantial mission design efforts requiring integration across USSF and external stakeholders. Mission Area Design Teams include appropriate representation from USSF S-Staff, FLDCOMs, SAF, PAEs, S&T organizations, other Services, Joint Staff, Combatant Commands, DoW offices, allies, partners, commercial, civil, and other required stakeholders. Mission Area Design Teams coordinate recommendations and stakeholder inputs at key Force Design decision points to capture stakeholder views, incorporate feedback, and ensure implementation of equities are addressed before recommendations advance to the Force Design Council.

3.3. Force Design Council. The Force Design Council is the GO/FO-level forum to converge on Force Design recommendations and determine the appropriate path for approval, transition, or external coordination. The council considers recommendations from Mission Area Design Teams at key decision points, including team formulation and analytic approach, COA down-selection, MAD recommendations, Objective Force implications, and Force Development transition recommendations. When concurrence is not achieved, the council captures stakeholder views, identifies unresolved issues, and determines whether the recommendation requires additional analysis, senior leader decision, transition to Force Development, or coordination through external governance fora.

3.3.1. Governance. The Force Design Council is chaired by the SF/S9 Director, with SF/S9 serving as the secretariat. SF/S5/8 is a core member and key stakeholder for requirements, programming, force structure, and implementation implications. Core membership also includes USSF HQ L2s and SAF. Additional participants are included as required to ensure the appropriate expertise and authorities are represented. The council meets at least quarterly and as needed to support Force Design decision timeline.

3.3.2. Senior Leader and External Governance. Recommendations involving requirements-versus-affordability trades, major force structure growth, significant risk acceptance, enterprise dependencies, Objective Force updates, major MAD outcomes, or Service Force Design direction may be elevated to the VCSO or CSO, as appropriate. Recommendations with Joint, Department, inter-Service, allied, partner, commercial, or civil equities are coordinated through existing governance forums to the maximum extent practicable, including Joint requirements forums when needed to inform performance metric recommendations or identify external dependencies.

3.3.3. Staffing and Recommendations. The Force Design Council enables convergence on recommendations, captures stakeholder views when convergence cannot be reached, and addresses unresolved issues both within and external to the USSF before recommendations advance to the appropriate approval authority. SF/S9 leads staffing for Force Design recommendations, in coordination with SF/S5/8.

Chapter 4

FORCE DESIGN ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

4.1. Chief of Space Operations (CSO) in the capacity of the Force Design Architect for Space Systems of the Armed Forces.

4.1.1. Approves the Objective Force and any additions, removals, and modifications, as applicable.

4.1.2. Sets USSF policies and strategic goals for force structure and posture, modernization, and capability development for all space mission capabilities that generate effects in, from, and to space supporting requirements of the joint force.

4.1.3. Validates the Force Design CoL Plan.

4.1.4. As the Force Design Architect of Space for the Armed Forces, approves the annual SRA to inform Joint Force assessments and design.

4.2. Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Space Acquisition and Integration (SAF/SQ).

4.2.1. Leads space architecture and capability integration with respect to the acquisition of the space systems and programs of the Armed Forces, pursuant to 10 U.S.C. § 9016(b)(6)(B)(i), in coordination with SF/S5/8.

4.2.2. Provides acquisition, technology, commercial, and international partnership inputs to inform Force Design activities.

4.2.3. Collaborates with SF/S9, executes S&T prioritization and ensures acquisition program alignment with acquisition related statutes and directives.

4.2.4. Assesses the Objective Force to ensure its materiel aspects and S&T needs are realistic and achievable.

4.2.5. Assigns newly identified capabilities, articulated in validated requirements, to a Program Acquisition Executive (PAE) portfolio.

4.2.6. Assesses the Objective Force to ensure it considers the integration requirements necessary for seamless interoperability with programmed and current force structure.

4.2.7. Supports Force Design activities and forums as requested.

4.2.8. Identifies Space Enterprise integration requirements.

4.2.9. Coordinates with SF/S9 to ensure enterprise-level integration, governance, and prioritization of space architecture in alignment with Objective Force.

4.2.10. Conducts and enforces System-of-Systems Engineering (SoSE), mission thread analysis, and integration analysis to ensure seamless interoperability.

4.2.11. Identifies opportunities, mitigates critical gaps, and addresses redundancies in space capabilities to optimize toward the Objective Force.

4.2.12. Provides assessment of current and planned space architectures to align Objective Force recommendations with national security requirements.

4.2.13. Identifies and develops requirements, interfaces, standards, and mission threads that span PAEs.

4.2.14. Generates integration solution artifacts to close identified risks, issues, or gaps. These artifacts may include, but are not limited to, integrating requirements, Statement of Work (SOW) language, enterprise integration standards, and policy memos to drive DOTmLPF-P solutions and ensure integration across PAEs and systems in space enterprise.

4.2.15. Provides digital representation of systems as they evolve throughout the acquisitions process to inform MAD and assess progress towards achieving the current Objective Force.

4.2.16. Supports Force Design activities and forums as requested.

4.3. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Human Capital (SF/S1).

4.3.1. Provides long-term manpower projections to inform each MAD and the overall Objective Force.

4.3.2. Provides assessments of personnel requirements and projections to support force structure analysis and to inform MAD recommendations.

4.3.3. Supports Force Design activities and forums, as requested.

4.4. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Intelligence (SF/S2).

4.4.1. Provides intelligence and projections of foreign governmental, civil, and commercial space capabilities, as able to inform the development of the FOE and the Force Design inputs to include consolidating intelligence-related strategic guidance.

4.4.2. Provides threat information, models, and intelligence on threat systems to support analysis and inform MAD COA recommendations.

4.4.3. Assesses the Objective Force to ensure that it addresses projected threats.

4.4.4. Supports Force Design activities and forums, as requested.

4.5. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Operations (SF/S3/4/7).

4.5.1. Provides relevant strategic inputs, including guidance related to operations and logistics, in support of Force Design inputs and activities.

4.5.2. Reviews and advocates for relevant DOTmLPF-P requirements and projections to support COA analysis and to inform MAD recommendations.

4.5.3. Assesses the Objective Force to ensure the various capabilities are identified as well as the associated force structure and sustainment requirements are purpose built, realistic, and achievable.

4.5.4. Supports Force Design activities and forums as requested.

4.6. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Strategy, Plans, Programs and Requirements (SF/S5/8).

4.6.1. Develops resource projection estimates for each mission area and identifies collaboration opportunities with commercial entities, allies, and partners as inputs to the Force Design Request Memo, ensuring a commercial-first analysis approach.

4.6.2. Facilitates coordination of force design performance recommendations with Joint FCBs and other requirements forums, as required.

4.6.3. Develops and updates RAP for programming, planning, budget, and execution integration.

4.6.4. Assesses the Objective Force to ensure the various capabilities are identified as well as the associated force structure and sustainment requirements are purpose built, realistic, and achievable.

4.6.5. Provides current joint space requirement documents to inform Force Design efforts.

4.6.6. Generates an annual space risk assessment report on space system capabilities for the CSO.

4.6.7. Identifies potential cooperative opportunities with commercial/civil/interagency entities, allies, and partners in support of force design.

4.6.8. Supports Force Design activities and forums, as requested.

4.7. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Cyber and Data (SF/S6).

4.7.1. Provides relevant strategic inputs, including guidance related to cyber, data and communications.

4.7.2. Reviews and advocates for relevant DOTmLPF-P requirements and projections to support COA analysis and to inform recommendations and integration into MADs.

4.7.3. Assesses the Objective Force to provide feedback on materiel changes and impacts in Cyber, Cybersecurity, Communications, Information Technology (C3IT), Information Technology, data, software, Artificial Intelligence (AI), Satellite Communications (SATCOM), and Electromagnetic Spectrum Operations (EMSO).

4.7.4. Provides cyber, data, communications and C2-related S&T needs in support of S&T prioritization.

4.7.5. Supports Force Design activities and forums as requested.

4.8. Space Force Test and Evaluation Directorate (SF/TE).

4.8.1. Reviews and advocates for relevant DOTmLPF-P requirements and projections to support COA analysis and to inform MAD recommendations.

4.8.2. Provides a formal testability and T&E resource risk assessment for COA down selection.

4.8.3. Supports Force Design activities and forums as requested.

4.9. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Force Design & Analysis (SF/S9).

4.9.1. Supports the CSO’s responsibilities as the Force Design Architect for Space Systems of the Armed Forces.

4.9.2. Oversees execution of the Force Design process and develops, staffs, publishes, and recommends updates to the Objective Force as the primary Service document.

4.9.3. Develops and approves the USSF Future Operating Environment and emerging and future concepts that guide Force Design activities.

4.9.4. Solicits Force Design input from across the USSF, SAF, and others through an annual Force Design Request Memo.

4.9.5. Develops and coordinates the five-year Force Design Campaign of Learning (CoL).

4.9.6. Integrates analysis inputs from across the enterprise to ensure MADs and the Objective Force are fully burdened across DOTmLPF-P at the level of fidelity required to assess feasibility, affordability, and risk.

4.9.7. Establishes and leads cross-functional MAD Teams to integrate operational, acquisition, intelligence, policy, resource, joint, allied, partner, and commercial considerations before key Force Design decision points.

4.9.8. Chairs the GO/FO-level Force Design Council to promote early cross-organizational collaboration, capture stakeholder views, address unresolved issues, and support timely recommendations to senior leaders.

4.9.9. Provides MAD recommendation and submission, in coordination with HQ staff, for VCSO endorsement, Joint and DoW GO/FO coordination, CSO approval, and integration into the Objective Force.

4.9.10. Conducts experimentation and prototyping and prioritizes USSF future capability and technology needs in coordination with SAF/SQ, AFRL, and other stakeholders to align S&T with Objective Force needs.

4.10. Combat Forces Command (CFC).

4.10.1. Identifies/provides weapon system modernization and mission growth requirements including DOTmLPF-P and interoperability requirements such as manpower, infrastructure, facility, mission support, training, equipment, capability development, and other combat mission needs that are needed to deliver combat credible force elements to inform MAD development and recommendation.

4.10.2. Assists the integration of MADs into the Objective Force, validating any dependencies between mission areas and minimizing inadvertent impacts while streamlining redundancies.

4.10.3. Assesses the Objective Force to ensure the various capabilities that it identifies as well as the associated force structure and sustainment requirements are realistic and achievable.

4.10.4. Provides operational-related S&T needs in support of S&T prioritization.

4.10.5. Supports Force Design activities and forums as requested.

4.10.6. Provides input identifying mission area gaps to drive force design priorities into the MAD.

4.11. Space Training and Readiness Command (STARCOM).

4.11.1. Estimates DOTmLPF-P impacts during mission analysis to inform MAD and Objective Force development and recommendations.

4.11.2. Supports S&T requirements generation and prioritization from Operational, Training, Test, and Readiness perspective.

4.11.3. Supports Force Design activities and forums as requested.

4.12. Other Services, Interagency, and CCMD LNOs.

4.12.1. Supports MAD development and provides feedback, as necessary.

4.12.2. Estimates the DOTmLPF-P changes required to support the MAD COAs as necessary.

4.12.3. Supports Force Design activities and forums as requested.

4.13. Portfolio Acquisition Executive (PAE) & other Acquisition Organizations.

4.13.1. Identifies applicable partnership opportunities with commercial entities, allies, and partners in support of the Force Design activities.

4.13.2. Reviews estimated DOTmLPF-P requirements during MAD, ensuring they are consistent with the technical characteristics of the systems within each COA to inform down-selection and integration.

4.13.3. Provides acquisition-related S&T needs in support of S&T prioritization.

4.13.4. Supports Force Design activities and forums as requested.

4.14. Science & Technology Enterprise Organization Leadership.

4.14.1. SF/S9 coordinates S&T enterprise efforts for the USSF with AFRL, the Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency, Service Labs, Federally Funded Research and Development Centers, and University Affiliated Research Centers to address subsequent items in this section.

4.14.2. Supports Force Design activities and forums as requested.

Chapter 5

FORCE DEVELOPMENT

5.1. Purpose. This Chapter serves as an authoritative description of Force Development and the integration of the four LOEs comprised therein. As the primary output of the Force Design process and the central guiding document for all Service activities, the Objective Force drives each of the four Force Development LOEs – Strategy & Integration, Capability Development, Resource Allocation, and Future Technology & Innovation. In some instances, CSO's may issue a Decision Memorandum that also drive these LOE. During Force Development, the CSO's Decision Memorandum serves as the primary mechanism to communicate service priorities and direct planning and resourcing activities. The specific governance frameworks for each individual LOEs are addressed separately in dedicated documents.

5.2. Description. Force Development is a dynamic and integrated framework designed to translate the long-term strategic vision for space capabilities, the Objective Force, into tangible, fielded realities for the warfighter. It functions as a continuous, cyclical engine rather than a linear, step-by-step procedure and is the second phase of the Force Modernization Continuum – Force Design, Force Development, Force Generation, and Force Employment.

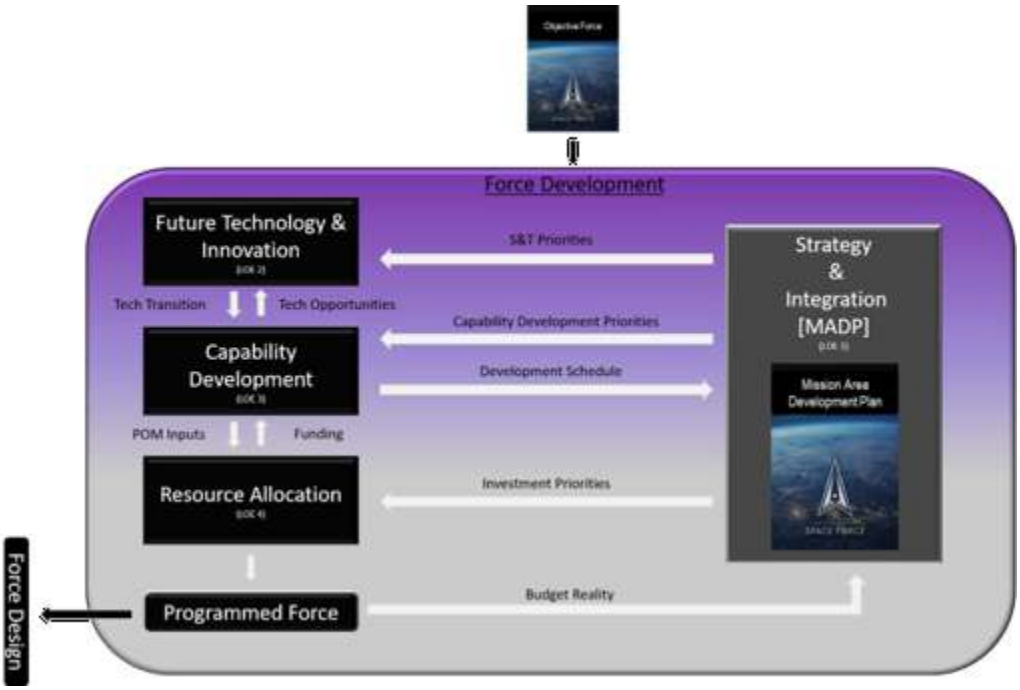
5.3. Force Development Process. The USSF Force Development process is a deliberate, integrated, and adaptive framework for translating the strategic vision of the Objective Force into fielded operational capabilities. The process is designed as a continuous, iterative cycle, not a linear sequence, to ensure synchronization and responsiveness.

5.3.1. Sequencing. Force Development operates through four distinct but interconnected phases, all synchronized via MAWGs centralized around the master plan called the MADP, which is driven and scoped by the Objective Force.

5.3.1.1. Mission Area Working Groups (MAWGs). MAWGs are enduring, interdisciplinary groups of action officers that serve as the analytical bodies integrating cross-functional expertise to support USSF Force Development activities. It is chaired by HQSF/S5/8's delegated O-6 or equivalent. MAWGs independently provide input to the annual FSA report, assessing the alignment of USSF Programmed Force to the Objective Force.

5.3.1.2. Lines of Effort (LOEs). The Force Development process operates through four distinct interconnected and iterative phases, all synchronized by a central master plan, the MADP.

Figure 5.1. Force Development LOEs.



5.4. Strategy & Integration (LOE 1). This LOE serves as the central coordinating function for the entire process. It is responsible for developing, maintaining, and adapting the MADP as the authoritative roadmap. It ensures synchronization by monitoring progress across all LOEs and adjusting the plan based on performance feedback, resource constraints, and emerging opportunities. Once the MADP is established, S&T, capability development, and investment priorities are passed to the other force development LOEs. This phase constantly monitors progress and adapts the plan based on feedback from the other phases, ensuring all efforts remain synchronized.

5.4.1. Key Activities. This LOE's key activities focus on building the foundational roadmap, adjusting to performance realities, and conveying clear priorities across the development enterprise.

5.4.1.1. Create and Maintain the MADP. The primary activity is creating and continuously updating the MADP for each mission area. This is not a static document - it's a living roadmap and the key output.

5.4.1.2. Track & Monitor Progress. This phase serves as the central hub for status updates. It constantly monitors progress from the other three phases to see if the plan is on track.

5.4.1.3. Provide Priorities. Based on the MADP, it directs the priorities for Future Technology & Innovation, Capability Development and Resource Allocation.

5.4.1.4. Assess & Adapt. When it receives feedback - like a budget cut from Resource Allocation or a technical delay from Capability Development - it assesses the impact and modifies the MADP to create a new, realistic plan, and communicates those changes to SF/S9 to inform Force Design activity.

5.4.2. Primary Outputs. MADP is the key output. This document captures the status, high-level road maps, and timelines for every capability within a given mission area. It documents any deviations from the Objective Force and their impact.

5.4.3. Key Organization(s).

5.4.3.1. SF/S5/8 is the organizational lead. This office is officially responsible for drafting, coordinating and maintaining the MADPs.

5.4.3.2. SF/S9 supports the development of the MADPs to ensure alignment with the Objective Force.

5.4.3.3. MAWGs are hands-on integrators. These interdisciplinary groups provide the corporate knowledge and cross-functional expertise needed to keep the MADPs accurate and relevant.

5.5. Future Technology & Innovation (LOE 2). This LOE identifies, prioritizes, and matures the S&T required to enable the Objective Force. It focuses on advancing next-generation capabilities and identifying emerging technological opportunities to ensure the USSF maintains a decisive technological advantage. Once potential technologies and innovations that align with the Objective Force are identified, they are shared with the Capability Development stakeholders for consideration as options to enable the attainment of the Objective Force. If the Capability Development stakeholders find the identified technologies to be viable solutions, they are transitioned to the Capability Development phase for further refinement and integration.

5.5.1. Key Activities. This LOE's key activities focus on analyzing gaps, projecting technology requirements, and partnering with research laboratories.

5.5.1.1. Identify S&T Needs. Analyzes the Objective Force to determine what new technologies will be required to make it a reality (e.g., a new sensor, a more efficient propulsion system, a new data processing algorithm).

5.5.1.2. Prioritize Research. Establishes the priorities for basic research, applied research, and advanced technology development across the S&T enterprise.

5.5.1.3. Scout for Opportunities. Actively looks for emerging commercial or academic technologies that could be leveraged to accelerate or improve a planned capability.

5.5.1.4. Coordinate S&T Enterprise. Works with a wide range of partners to include the Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency, the Air Force Research Laboratory (AFRL), Federally Funded Research and Development Centers and University Affiliated Research Centers to execute the research and development efforts.

5.5.2. Primary Outputs.

5.5.2.1. Technology Transition Plans. Roadmaps for taking a mature technology out of the lab and inserting it into a formal acquisition program within Capability Development.

5.5.2.2. Technology Readiness Assessments. Formal evaluations of new technology maturity.

5.5.3. Key Organization(s).

5.5.3.1. SF/S9 leads the strategic prioritization of S&T for the Service and conducts experimentation and prototype activities.

5.5.3.2. S&T Enterprise Organizations (e.g., AFRL) and centers that conduct hands-on research and development are key to this LOE.

5.5.3.3. SAF/SQ plays a key role in identifying partnership opportunities and aligning S&T efforts with acquisition pathways.

5.6. Capability Development (LOE 3). This LOE executes the MADP by transforming the architectural blueprint into a fully enabled operational capability. It synchronizes the acquisition of materiel systems with the concurrent development of all required DOTmLPF-P support elements.

5.6.1. Key Activities. This LOE's key activities translate strategic requirements into systems acquisition and personnel integration structures.

5.6.1.1. Establish Requirements. Translates the broad goals of the Objective Force into formal, requirement documents that are needed to start an acquisition program.

5.6.1.2. Acquire Systems. Managing the contracts and programs to design, build, field, and test the actual materiel (e.g., satellites, ground systems, software).

5.6.1.3. Build the Force Structure. Concurrently, this phase ensures all the non-materiel pieces (DOTmLPF-P) are put in place. This includes recruiting and training Guardians, developing new doctrine, building necessary facilities, and establishing new policies.

5.6.1.4. Accept & Integrate. Executes the formal process of system acceptance, ensuring the new capability is integrated with existing systems and ready for operations. This includes integrating commercial and allied capabilities.

5.6.2. Primary Output. An operationally accepted capability. The ultimate product is not just hardware, but an optimally burdened and integrated "combat-credible force element" that has been delivered/transitioned to the Force Employment phase of the Force Modernization Continuum.

5.6.3. Key Organization(s).

5.6.3.1. SF/S5/8 is the lead for developing the Mission Area Requirements Document (MARD), Enterprise Requirements Document (ERD), and associated Space Priority Requirements (SPR) to implement the Objective Force.

5.6.3.2. CFC is responsible for capability development for readiness such as sustainment and operations. Aggregates DOTmLPF-P requirements that are needed to deliver combat credible force elements during capability development.

5.6.3.3. STARCOM is responsible for the foundational training and education, and doctrine development aspects of DOTmLPF-P and provides test and evaluation support to the acquisition and operational fielding of materiel systems.

5.6.3.4. SF/S9 informs requirements generation and assesses alignment of acquisition activities to the Objective Force. Additionally, is responsible for the doctrine development aspect of DOTmLPF-P.

5.6.3.5. Portfolio Acquisition Executives and other Acquisition Organizations are the primary entities responsible for acquiring the materiel systems.

5.7. Resource Allocation (LOE 4). The purpose of this phase is to translate the strategic priorities of the MADP into a funded, executable program by allocating financial and personnel resources through the formal budgeting process, PPBE. This LOE governs the allocation of financial and personnel resources through the formal PPBE process and is responsible for translating the priorities of the MADP into a funded program, balancing future development needs against current force readiness to ensure the plan is fiscally sound and executable.

5.7.1. Key Activities. This LOE's key activities concern programmatic funding formulation, cross-priority balance, and fiscal execution tracking.

5.7.1.1. Budget Formulation. Annually updates the “Programmed Force” by building the POM, which is the service’s budget request to the Department of War.

5.7.1.2. Balancing Priorities. This is a critical balancing act. This phase must allocate limited resources in a way that advances the future Objective Force while also ensuring the current, fielded force has enough funding to be sustained and ready.

5.7.1.3. Financial Execution. Manages the execution of the budget once it is approved by Congress.

5.7.2. Primary Outputs.

5.7.2.1. The Programmed Force. The official record of capabilities, personnel, and infrastructure that have been allocated funding within the Future Years Defense Program (FYDP).

5.7.2.2. The Program Objective Memorandum (POM). The comprehensive budget request reflects the service’s priorities.

5.7.2.3. Resource Allocation Plan (RAP). The RAP is a continuously updated resourcing outlook that determines the priorities of investment toward the Objective Force and informs Force Development resourcing and the POM.

5.7.3. Key Organization(s).

5.7.3.1. SF/S5/8 is the lead for developing PPBE products including RAP, POM, and supporting budget exhibits.

5.7.3.2. The Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Financial Management and Comptroller (SAF/FM) manage the budget process and provides cost estimating support.

5.7.3.3. Portfolio Acquisition Executives, Acquisition Organizations and FLDCOMs provide the detailed cost data needed to build the budget.

5.7.3.4. SF/S9 supports PPBE prioritization and activities to ensure alignment with the Objective Force.

5.8. Resource Allocation and Programmatic Synchronization. Resource Allocation phase projects and programs based on Objective Force capabilities, supplying the detailed cost estimates and POM inputs required for execution. Consequently, this phase utilizes the PPBE process to weigh these requirements against service priorities and budgetary constraints. If funding is reduced, Strategy & Integration phase assesses the impact reported and adjusts the MADP accordingly. Ultimately, these updates inform the SF/S9 Force Design cycle and ensure revised priorities are synchronized across all efforts to prevent continued pursuit of unfunded initiatives. The effectiveness of the Force Development process hinges on the continuous and seamless integration of these four LOEs. This is achieved through a constant, bi-directional flow of information, coordinated by Strategy & Integration. This integrated force structure provides the adaptability required to systematically respond to resource adjustments, technological advancements, and evolving threats. The ultimate objective of the process is the consistent and efficient delivery of fully burdened, combat-credible space capabilities that empower the joint force and maintain a strategic advantage over adversaries.

Chapter 6

FORCE DEVELOPMENT ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

6.1. Chief of Space Operations (CSO) in the capacity of the Force Design Architect for Space Systems of the Armed Forces.

6.1.1. Sets USSF policies and strategic goals for force structure and posture, modernization, and capability development for all space-mission capabilities that generate effects in, from, and to space supporting requirements of the joint force.

6.1.2. Delivers recommendations to the Secretary of War and Assistant Secretary of War for Space Policy on policies and strategic goals for force structure, modernization, and capability development for all DoW space mission capabilities that generate effects in, from, and to space.

6.2. Assistant Secretary of the Air Force for Space Acquisition and Integration (SAF/SQ).

6.2.1. Leads space architecture and capability integration with respect to the acquisition of the space systems and programs of the Armed Forces, pursuant to 10 U.S.C. § 9016(b)(6)(B)(i), in coordination with SF/S5/8.

6.2.2. Directs S&T prioritization and ensures acquisition program alignment with acquisition related statutes and directives.

6.2.3. Assesses the Objective Force to direct the development of capabilities and S&T needs to ensure Objective Force attainment.

6.2.4. Coordinates with SF/S5/8 and acquisition organizations, as required, in developing and updating the RAP as well as the POM.

6.2.5. Reviews MADPs to ensure they reflect the latest status of on-going S&T and acquisitions-related development efforts, providing updates as needed.

6.2.6. Assigns Objective Force newly identified capabilities to PAE portfolio.

6.2.7. Monitors requirements, interfaces, and mission threads that span PAEs, identifying any issues through participation in MAWGs.

6.2.8. Monitors and reports annually to the CSO and the Secretary of the Air Force on progress toward attainment of the Objective Force.

6.2.9. Monitors and assesses acquisition program execution, re-allocating funding as necessary, and informing the force development process to ensure Objective Force capabilities are delivered on time and on budget.

6.2.10. Identifies Space Enterprise integration requirements.

6.2.11. Leads and enforces Space Enterprise-level integration, governance, and prioritization of the Programmed Force in alignment with the Objective Force.

6.2.12. Conducts SoSE and integration analysis to promote seamless interoperability across armed forces.

6.2.13. Provides recommendations to drive system acquisition priorities into an integrated space enterprise.

6.2.14. Identifies opportunities, mitigates critical gaps, and addresses redundancies in space capabilities to optimize Objective Force attainment.

6.2.15. Coordinates with SF/S/5/8 and stakeholders to track the progress of system integration efforts, ensuring end-to-end capability delivery and mission thread alignment. This alignment shall be maintained and enforced by Integration PAE.

6.2.16. Supports other Force Development activities and forums, as requested.

6.3. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Human Capital (SF/S1).

6.3.1. Assesses Objective Force and provides assessments of personnel requirements and projections to ensure Objective Force attainment.

6.3.2. Coordinates with functional authorities, to include Career Field Managers, to provide estimated manpower needs for the RAP.

6.3.3. Reviews and develops recommended updates to Guardian development plans within MADPs to ensure the roadmap for manpower is executable.

6.3.4. Supports other Force Development efforts and forums, as requested.

6.3.5. Provides representative(s) to MAWGs to support collaborative Force Development efforts.

6.4. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Intelligence (SF/S2).

6.4.1. Assesses the new capability solutions to ensure they address projected threats highlighted in the Objective Force.

6.4.2. Supports other Force Development activities and forums, as requested.

6.4.3. Provides estimates of relevant DOTmLPF-P requirements and projections to support capability development.

6.4.4. Provides representative(s) to MAWGs to support collaborative Force Development efforts.

6.5. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Operations (SF/S3/4/7).

6.5.1. Coordinates on sustainment cost estimates from acquisition communities and long-term sustainment considerations to support RAP development.

6.5.2. Reviews and advocates for relevant DOTmLPF-P requirements and projections to support DOTmLPF-P analysis to ensure fully burdened and sustainable systems.

6.5.3. Provides sustainment needs for the RAP, ensuring funding for future sustainment requirements.

6.5.4. Assesses the Objective Force to ensure the various capabilities and associated force structure and sustainment requirements are purpose built, realistic, and achievable.

6.5.5. Reviews and updates relevant DOTmLPF-P plans within MADPs to ensure all DOTmLPF-P requirements are documented and met when new capabilities are operationally accepted.

6.5.6. Supports other Force Development efforts and forums, as requested.

6.5.7. Provides representative(s) to MAWGs to support Force Development efforts.

6.6. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Strategy, Plans, Programs and Requirements (SF/S5/8).

6.6.1. Creates and maintains MADPs based on the Objective Force and continuously updates the status of development efforts across the USSF. The MADP will inform priorities, decision-making and updates triggered by strategic guidance updates, or significant program status changes.

6.6.2. Facilitates coordination of Force Development products to ensure senior leadership alignment, as necessary.

6.6.3. Develops and updates RAP, POM, and other supporting budget exhibits for PPBE integration.

6.6.4. Develops and updates requirement documents to support Force Development efforts.

6.6.5. Manages and execute the SRA process to articulate current and future risks of space system capabilities for the CSO.

6.6.6. Supports other Force Development activities and forums, as requested.

6.6.7. Identifies potential cooperative opportunities with commercial/civil/interagency entities, allies, and partners in support of force development.

6.7. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Cyber and Data (SF/S6).

6.7.1. Reviews MADPs to incorporate timelines/actions needed to receive authorization to test/operate any applicable systems.

6.7.2. Provides impacts to ground infrastructure and networks (e.g. capacity, latency, processing) to ensure mission equipment and networks can accommodate the additional demand/load from newly developed capabilities/systems.

6.7.3. Supports other Force Development activities and forums, as requested.

6.7.4. Provides estimates of relevant DOTmLPF-P requirements and projections to support capability development.

6.7.5. Coordinates updates to MADPs to reflect changes in EMSO, including cyberspace and SATCOM, and how these changes might impact development efforts.

6.7.6. Advises on prioritization of C3IT, Data & AI, SATCOM, and EMSO challenges during implementation.

6.7.7. Assesses the Objective Force to provide inputs to capability development on materiel changes and impacts in cyberspace, SATCOM, and EMSO.

6.7.8. Provides representative(s) to MAWGs to support collaborative capability development.

6.8. Deputy Chief of Space Operations for Force Design & Analysis (SF/S9).

6.8.1. Supports Force Development activities by preserving Objective Force traceability into MADP development, requirements generation, Planning and Programming development and prioritization, and acquisition support.

6.8.2. Provides representative(s) to MAWGs to support Force Development efforts.

6.9. Space Force Test and Evaluation Directorate (SF/TE).

6.9.1. Advises and assists the CSO on all matters concerning USSF T&E. Also supports the Director of Test and Evaluation (AF/TE) as outlined in HAFMD 1-52, Director of Test and Evaluation.

6.9.2. Develops Test & Evaluation (T&E) policy and guidance and provides oversight of test execution, in coordination with HQ Staff, FLDCOMs, and SF/S9.

6.9.3. Advocates for T&E equities and resourcing of test capabilities and oversees T&E infrastructure investments supporting the Space Test Enterprise, including the Integrated Test Force construct and SFPAE-Infrastructure (Operational Test and Training Infrastructure (OTTI)).

6.9.4. Leads and executes the Service Foreign Materiel Program (FMP) as the source for all Foreign Materiel needs to properly resource a threat-informed SFPAE-Infrastructure (OTTI).

6.9.5. Reviews and develops recommended updates to relevant DOTmLPF-P plans to ensure test equities are captured.

6.9.6. Reviews and advocates for relevant DOTmLPF-P requirements and projections to support capability development.

6.9.7. Works with SF/S9 to inform USSF SFPAE-Infrastructure (OTTI) test capabilities and related infrastructure needs beyond the FYDP, and coordinates with joint, defense and national offices to roadmap major resource priorities in line with USSF Objective Force.

6.9.8. Participates in defining objective test criteria for Technology Readiness Assessments and co-developing the T&E strategies for the Technology Transition Plans.

6.9.9. Contributes to the development of the T&E infrastructure, manpower, and funding sections of the RAP.

6.9.10. Provides representative(s) to MAWGs to support collaborative capability development.

6.10. Combat Forces Command (CFC).

6.10.1. Identifies DOTmLPF-P requirements that are needed to deliver combat credible force elements during capability development.

6.10.2. Provides resourcing estimates needed to field fully burdened capabilities, during RAP updates.

6.10.3. Reviews MADPs to ensure they reflect the latest status of on-going efforts to implement DOTmLPF-P changes needed to achieve the Objective Force, providing updates as needed.

6.10.4. Provides operational-related S&T needs in support of S&T prioritization.

6.10.5. Supports other Force Development activities and forums, as requested.

6.10.6. Provides representative(s) to MAWGs to support collaborative MADP development.

6.10.7. Builds and submits POM inputs for capabilities to match future Fielded Force to the Objective Force.

6.11. Space Training and Readiness Command (STARCOM).

6.11.1. Provides estimates of relevant DOTmLPF-P requirements and projections to support capability development.

6.11.2. Provides resourcing estimates needed to field fully burdened capabilities, during RAP updates.

6.11.3. Reviews MADPs to ensure they reflect the latest status of on-going efforts to implement DOTmLPF-P changes needed to achieve the Objective Force, providing updates as needed.

6.11.4. Supports S&T requirements generation and prioritization from Operational, and foundational Training and Readiness perspective.

6.11.5. Supports other Force Development activities and forums, as requested.

6.11.6. Performs gap analysis on test and training capabilities to operationalize the Objective Force and identify new requirements for SFPAE-Infrastructure (OTTI) as necessary.

6.11.7. Provides representative(s) to MAWGs to support collaborative capability development.

6.11.8. Executes Operational Test and Evaluation of USSF systems.

6.12. Space System Command (SSC).

6.12.1. Organizes, trains, and equips acquisition professionals to support the PAEs and space laboratories.

6.12.2. Provides assured access to space for critical space capabilities.

6.12.3. Provides consolidated SSC POM and RAP inputs in conjunction with National Space Enterprise partners.

6.13. Portfolio Acquisition Executive (PAE) and other Acquisition Organizations.

6.13.1. Identifies applicable partnership opportunities with commercial entities, allies, and partners in support of capability development.

6.13.2. Reviews estimated DOTmLPF-P requirements during capability development ensuring they are aligned with the technical characteristics of the systems.

6.13.3. Validates Objective Force cost assessment prior to RAP integration.

6.13.4. Provides acquisition-related S&T needs in support of S&T prioritization.

6.13.5. Provides estimates of the fully burdened resourcing need to field capabilities identified by the Objective Force, during RAP updates.

6.13.6. Assesses the Objective Force capability requirements and collaborate with SF/S5/8 to define, derive and document system requirements, as requested.

6.13.7. Directs the acquisition of the new systems and supporting infrastructure, ensuring Objective Force attainment.

6.13.8. Provides updates to MADPs to reflect the status of on-going acquisitions-related development efforts.

6.13.9. Supports other Force Design activities and forums, as requested.

6.13.10. Provides representative(s) to MAWGs to support collaborative MADP development.

6.13.11. Builds and submits POM inputs for capabilities to match future Fielded Force to Objective Force.

6.13.12. Provides applicable international/commercial capabilities in support of Objective Force attainment.

6.13.13. Develops and updates system requirement documents to support Force Development efforts.

6.14. Science & Technology Enterprise Organizations.

6.14.1. Coordinates S&T enterprise efforts for the USSF with Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency, Service Labs, Federally Funded Research and Development Centers, and University Affiliated Research Centers to address subsequent items in this section.

6.14.2. Provides applicable international/commercial capabilities and partnership opportunities in support of Force Development.

6.14.3. Supports MADP by providing any information needed to support capability development.

6.14.4. Assesses the Objective Force to provide feedback on any S&T updates and prioritization needed for implementation.

6.14.5. Provides updates to MADPs to reflect the status of on-going S&T development efforts.

6.14.6. Supports other Force Development activities and forums, as requested.

6.15. Other Services, Interagency, and CCMD LNOs.

6.15.1. Provides estimates of relevant DOTmLPF-P requirements and projections to support capability development.

6.15.2. Supports other Force Development efforts and forums, as requested.

SHAWN N. BRATTON
General, USSF
Vice Chief of Space Operations

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

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DoDD 7045.14, *The Planning, Programming, Budgeting, and Execution (PPBE) Process,* 25 January 2013

CJCSI 3030.01B, *Implementing Joint Force Development and Design,* 1 July 2025

CJCSM 5123.01, *Manual for the Joint Requirements Oversight Council and the Joint Force Requirements Process,* 15 January 2026

DAFPD 13-6, *Space Policy,* 5 December 2023

DAFI 63-101/20-101, *Integrated Life Cycle Management,* 23 October 2024

SPFI 13-604, *System Acceptance*, 30 August 2023

JROCM 046-23, *Joint Integrator for Space requirements,* 29 June 2023

CSO EXORD, *Optimizing the USSF for Great Power Competition,* 23 May 2024

Force Design Architect for Space Systems of the Armed Forces – *A Framework for Designing Tomorrow's Force,* October 2024

Memorandum for Director, *Space Systems Integration Office, Chief Space Systems Engineer and Director, Space Systems Integration Office (SSIO) Appointment,* 9 July 2024

Space Force *Vector 2025,* 13 November 2025

Department of Defense. (2025). *National defense strategy of the United States of America*.

Space *Force Doctrine Document 1 (SFDD-1),* Appendix B

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 679, Air Force Publication Compliance Item Waiver Request/Approval

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AFRL—Air Force Research Laboratory

CCMD—Combatant Command

CFC—Combat Forces Command

CJCSI—Chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff Instruction

CRC—Concept Required Capabilities

CSO—Chief of Space Operations

C3IT—Cyber, Cybersecurity, Communications, Information Technology

DAF—Department of the Air Force

DAFI—Department of the Air Force Instruction

DAFPD—Department of the Air Force Policy Directive

DoD—Department of Defense

DoDD—Department of Defense Directive

DoDI—Department of Defense Instruction

DOTmLPF-P—Doctrine, Organization, Training, materiel, Leadership and Education, Personnel, Facilities, and Policy

DoW—Department of War

DRU—Direct Reporting Units

EMSO—Electromagnetic Spectrum Operations

EP&I—Enterprise Planning and Integration

FDD—Force Design and Development

FMP—Foreign Materiel Program

FOE—Future Operating Environment

FLDCOM—Field Command

FSA—Force Structure Assessment

FYDP—Future Years Defense Program

GO/FO—General Officer/Flag Officer

HQ—Headquarters

IAW—In Accordance With

LOE—Line of Effort

MAD—Mission Area Design

MADP—Mission Area Development Plan

MAWGs—Mission Area Working Groups

MS&A—Modeling, Simulation, & Analysis

OPR—Office of Primary Responsibility

OTTI—Operational Test and Training Infrastructure

PAE—Program Acquisition Executive

POM—Program Objective Memorandum

PPBE—Planning, Programming, Budgeting, and Execution

RAP—Resource Allocation Plan

SATCOM—Satellite Communications

SoSE—System-of-Systems Engineering

SFDD—Space Force Doctrine Document

SRA—Space Risk Assessment

S&T—Science & Technology

USSF—United States Space Force

Terms

Campaign of Learning Plan—A five-year plan that establishes the scope, focus, priorities, and sequencing for Force Design activities and serves as the USSF central plan for executing Force Design.

Concept—Concepts address emerging operational challenges, propose solutions, and identify required capabilities through collaboration, engagement and rigor, to enhance the operational effectiveness of the joint force. The USSF develops military concepts to propose solutions to future challenges and thereby inform the Force Design and Force Development processes.

CSO Decision Memorandum—The CSO Decision Memorandum delivers strategic enterprise guidance to the force. During Force Design, it serves as the CSO's primary mechanism to communicate priorities, direct efforts, and scope Force Design Analysis and concept exploration. During Force Development, the memorandum similarly communicates service priorities while directing downstream planning and resourcing.

Fielded Force—Forces as currently constituted. Comprises the warfighting capabilities, systems, facilities, infrastructure, and combat units of action generated, sustained, and presented or able to be presented to combatant commanders. Example: Composite Force offering of combat squadrons.

Force—An aggregation of military personnel, weapon systems, equipment, and necessary support, or combination thereof (DoD Dictionary of Military and Associated Terms). Example: Combat Squadron or Combat Detachment.

Force Design—A Force Design is the blueprint for the force that expresses: the size of the force in manpower and equipment; the structure of the force; the concepts and capabilities the force uses to conduct its missions, training, posture; and other activities to achieve national objectives. Designing the force includes activities that alter the operational missions the force is meant to achieve; the capabilities and concepts the force employs to support strategic objectives; or the structure of the force as expressed by manpower and materiel at the Service and departmental level. Force Design activities leverage experimentation, doctrine, education, training, lessons learned, and capability development to advance and validate ideas. (CJCSI 3030.01B)

Force Development—Force Development is the execution of activities designed to prepare the joint force to fulfill national defense and security objectives in the present and future. DoW Components develop their forces to be more proficient in their assigned and expected missions, and to conceive new and better ways to accomplish those missions. Force Development is conducted to improve the way the joint force currently operates by enhancing execution of assigned missions and current capabilities through experimentation, doctrine, education, training, lessons learned, and capability development. (CJCSI 3030.01B)

Force Employment—Force Employment is the daily use of the current force on missions and activities directed by national strategy, operational requirements, and senior leader guidance. Employment activities include training, education, and exercises. These activities build near-term force readiness, campaign to create competitive advantage, and secure required global force posture, while also adapting the force to changes in the operating environment and the character of war. CCMDs employ the joint force around the world daily in operations and activities across the competition continuum for readiness, stabilization, competition, deterrence, and combat. (CJCSI 3030.01B)

Force Generation—Force Generation is the Service-level activity that builds, sustains, and reconstitutes force elements to conduct prompt and sustained operations. Force Generation leverages the Fielded Force to present capability to Combatant Commanders.

Force Structure Assessment—Reviews the entire mission area as a whole by analyzing the projected lifecycle costs and identifying all supporting and enabling infrastructure requirements for the approved capability solutions. The purpose of the assessment is to ensure that all the planned capabilities within the mission area have the required supporting and enabling infrastructure properly identified and budgeted.

Mission Area Design Course of Action (MAD COA)—system or system of systems design meant to guide and constrain the instantiations of Force Development without presupposing the capability requirements of the material solutions. MAD COAs capture assumptions, results, and fulfillment of gaps documented in the Force Design Request Memo. COAs consider multiple approaches to achieving the desired end state. COAs must be: Feasible: Can accomplish the mission within the established time, space, and resource limitations. Acceptable in terms of risk, cost, and potential benefits. Suitable aligning with the Commander's intent and guidance. Distinguishable: Identify how the solution differs significantly from other potential solutions.

Materiel Solution—Denotes all items (including satellites, ground systems, antennas, etc. and related spares, repair parts, and support equipment, but excluding real property, installations, and utilities) necessary to equip, operate, maintain, and support space activities without distinction as to its application for administrative or combat purposes. (adapted from CJCSI 5123.01I)

Mission Area—A major grouping of interrelated activities that must be performed to accomplish a core function. Mission areas are comprised of mission sets.

Mission Needs—collection of inputs aimed at modifying the Fielded Force. Examples: threats, updated national guidance, new or modified concepts, emerging needs (Joint Emergent Operational Need/Joint Urgent Operational Need), or Force Assessments.

Non-materiel Solution—Changes to doctrine, organization, training, (fielded) materiel, leadership and education, personnel, facilities, and/or policy, implemented to satisfy one or more capability requirements (or needs) and reduce or eliminate one or more capability gaps. (adapted from CJCSI 5123.01I)

Objective Force—The Objective Force describes the idealized capabilities, capacity, and force structure required for Guardians to accomplish their missions and defeat a thinking adversary over the next three Future Years Defense Programs (FYDPs). This includes all the things required for the force to be effective across the DOTmLPF-P planning process, such as manpower, simulators, test ranges, networks, and other materiel and non-materiel combat support. (Space Force Vector 2025)

Principal Staff Assistant—Senior designated official or staff officer who serves as the primary advisor, policy developer, and authoritative focal point for a specific functional portfolio, reporting directly to the highest echelon of leadership (such as CSO, VCSO, SecAF, etc).

Programmed Force—Consists of the capabilities, facilities, infrastructure, personnel, S&T investments, etc., that have been allocated funding through the PPBE process over the course of the 1st FYDP. The Programmed Force is not static and changes from one POM cycle to the next. Differences between the Objective Force and the Programmed Force indicate areas of strategic regret, acquisition strategies, and plans when engaging with industry.

Space Risk Assessment—The annual assessment of operational risk across all mission areas, informed by capability gaps, force design analysis, and Joint inputs; supports the CRA and Joint Force Design. Managed by HQSF S5/8.